

Russell Dudek

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Ashley Lepczyk
Chief Operating Officer
Foundation Data

Dear Ashley,

Foundation Data is not hiring this role simply to coordinate projects. The actual work is to make a growing portfolio of Scout, tagging, analytics, marketing, data, and AI initiatives carry revenue and scale without forcing leadership to reconstruct every dependency personally.

That operating problem closely matches the work I have done across technical, customer-facing, and high-consequence environments. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows. At Amazon, I built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, and standard work in a 24/7 customer-backward system supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. Earlier, at Compunetics, I connected engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs through measurable controls and operating cadence.

I also work directly in AI-enabled workflow design. Through DudeWorth, I develop opportunity frameworks and agentic patterns that connect value, data readiness, human authority, evaluation, governance, adoption burden, and time-to-value. My bias is not to add AI to a process and call the work complete. It is to redesign the workflow, define where people retain authority, instrument the result, and redeploy the capacity that is actually released.

My thesis for Foundation Data is simple: make strategy load-bearing. Each strategic initiative should expose the customer decision it improves, the economic logic it carries, one accountable owner, cross-functional dependencies, capacity and trust conditions, and the evidence that changes the next allocation decision. A lightweight weekly Initiative Load Review would then let leadership accelerate, sequence, repair, or stop work without adding PMO drag.

That operating posture fits the company Foundation Data presents publicly: small, direct, pragmatic, remote-first, and built around real ownership and visible impact. I would bring a hands-on cadence rather than a layer of ceremony—quarterly planning that begins with customer and financial outcomes, weekly exception review, simple milestone confidence, and dashboards whose measures have an owner and a decision threshold. The purpose is not more reporting. It is clearer allocation, faster dependency closure, more reliable forecasts, and more leadership capacity for OEM, NCM, customer, and partnership work.

My immediate contribution would be practical: create one decision-ready view of the strategic portfolio; establish a weekly exception cadence that closes ownership and dependency gaps; and prove one AI-enabled workflow where released capacity is measured and deliberately redeployed. Those mechanisms would give Finance and leadership a clearer connection between engineering time, customer value, forecast confidence, and gross-profit priorities.

The independent candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/Foundation/> makes this approach tangible through an interactive Execution Load Test, a complete 120-day entry plan, and an operating review designed for Scout, tagging, analytics, and AI-enabled capacity. The work is grounded in Foundation Data's public strategy and presented as a hypothesis for discovery, not as a claim about undisclosed internal conditions.

I would welcome a conversation about which decisions you most want this role to absorb, where the portfolio currently carries hidden load, and what evidence would give the leadership team greater confidence to move faster.

Respectfully, Russell Dudek